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Stripe Account Setup

TimeVault — Client Onboarding

TimeVault takes card payments, holds each payment for a period the user chooses, then pays the money out to that user's own bank account. That payout leg means a standard Stripe account is not enough — the account must also be approved for **Stripe Connect with Custom accounts**. That approval is the only step with a waiting period, so it should be started first.

PREPARED FOR	**TimeVault — client onboarding**
APPLIES TO	**api.timevaultapp.co and the TimeVault mobile app**
DATE	**18 September 2026**
AUDIENCE	**Business owner / account holder**

Every click, in order

#	WHERE TO CLICK IN STRIPE	WHAT YOU DO	WHAT TO COPY OUT
1	dashboard.stripe.com/register	Sign up with a company email	—
2	Orange **Activate your account** banner	Business details, bank account, ID	—
3	Gear → **Team and security** → Two-step authentication	Turn on 2FA	—
4	Sidebar → **Connect** → Get started → Platform or marketplace → **Custom**	Submit, then wait 3–10 days	—
5	Top right → **Test mode** toggle	Switch on, for rows 6–7	—
6	**Developers** → **API keys**	Reveal both keys	`pk_test_…`, `sk_test_…`
7	**Developers** → **Webhooks** → Add endpoint	Add the URL and 3 events	`whsec_…`
8	—	Send the three values to the development team	—
9	Top right → turn **Test mode** off	Repeat rows 6–7 in live mode	`pk_live_…`, `sk_live_…`, new `whsec_…`

> Rows 1–3 take about half an hour. **Row 4 is the only step with a waiting period — do it first, on day one.** Rows 5–8 can all be completed while the application is pending.

Steps 1–3 — Account, Connect, keys

1. Create and verify the account

Sign up at dashboard.stripe.com/register with a company email more than one person can reach — Stripe sends password resets and risk notices there. Turn on two-factor authentication, then complete **Activate your account**: business type and registration number, address, directors, and the business bank account Stripe pays TimeVault's own revenue into. Upload ID when asked; verification usually clears in one to two business days.

2. Apply for Connect with Custom accounts

Open **Connect** in the sidebar → **Get started** → **Platform or marketplace** → account type **Custom**. Standard and Express will not work: the app creates accounts through the API and collects bank details in its own screens. Complete the platform profile — who your users are, what they are paid for, average payout size and expected monthly volume — then submit and wait for approval by email.

3. Collect the API keys

Go to Developers → API keys. The **Test mode** toggle at the top right changes which keys are shown.

KEY	LOOKS LIKE	USED BY	SECRET?
Publishable key	`pk_…`	The mobile app, to show the card form	No
Secret key	`sk_…`	The server, to charge cards and send payouts	**Yes**

> Send keys through a password manager or encrypted channel — never email or chat. The live secret key can move money out of the business's account. If one is ever exposed, click **Roll key** in the dashboard immediately.

Step 4 — Create the webhook endpoint

A webhook is how Stripe tells TimeVault a payment actually succeeded. Without it a user could be charged and the app would never record it — this step is not optional. Go to Developers → Webhooks → **Add endpoint** and set the URL to:

```
https://api.timevaultapp.co/api/stripe/webhook
```

Under **Select events**, add exactly these three:

EVENT	WHAT IT MEANS
`payment_intent.succeeded`	The card was charged; start the hold period
`payment_intent.payment_failed`	The charge was declined; tell the user
`payment_intent.canceled`	The payment was abandoned or cancelled

Save, open the endpoint, reveal the **Signing secret** — it begins `whsec_` — and copy it. Treat it like the secret key.

> Test and live mode have **separate endpoints and separate signing secrets**. This endpoint is created twice — once in test mode, once at go-live. Using the test secret against live traffic makes every webhook fail verification, and payments silently stop being recorded.

Step 5 — Send these values to the development team

Nothing else from the Stripe account is needed. The account password is never required.

VALUE	FROM	EXAMPLE
Publishable key	Step 3	`pk_live_51Ab…`
Secret key	Step 3	`sk_live_51Ab…`
Webhook signing secret	Step 4	`whsec_7Kd…`

The development team also needs these URLs confirmed. All must be `https` and publicly reachable — Stripe rejects `http`, `localhost` and IP addresses.

```
Platform website              https://timevaultapp.co
Return after payment          https://api.timevaultapp.co/api/stripe/payment/return
Return after bank onboarding  https://api.timevaultapp.co/api/stripe/connect/return
Payment succeeded page        https://timevaultapp.co/payment/success
Payment failed page           https://timevaultapp.co/payment/failed
```

Step 6 — Go live

Only after Connect approval and a successful test payment. Switch out of **Test mode**, collect the **live** keys, create the webhook endpoint again in live mode with the same URL and events, and send all three live values across. Then take one real payment for the smallest amount the app allows, confirm the webhook returned `200`, and refund it.

> **To confirm before we finalise:** the country the business is registered in, the currencies to accept at launch (the app supports USD, EUR and GBP), and whether the live domain is `timevaultapp.co`.

TimeVault — Stripe Account Setup · 18 September 2026 · Contains no account credentials.